

Envelope Gift Card Holder

BEGINNER SEWING PATTERN · MAKES 1

Materials

- **Two pieces, $3\frac{1}{2}\text{in} \times 4\frac{1}{2}\text{in}$** – the outside and the lining. Quilting cotton is easiest.
- **Four squares, $3\text{in} \times 3\text{in}$** – the folded corners. A contrasting print.
- Matching thread
- Sewing machine (or a needle and patience)
- Pins or clips, scissors, iron

No interfacing. No fastening. The folded corners hold the card in on their own.

Key Numbers

Body – cut 2 $3\frac{1}{2}\text{in} \times 4\frac{1}{2}\text{in}$

Corners – cut 4 $3\text{in} \times 3\text{in}$

Seam allowance $\frac{1}{4}\text{in}$

Finished size $4\text{in} \times 3\text{in}$

A gift card is $3\frac{3}{8}\text{in} \times 2\frac{1}{8}\text{in}$. That leaves $\frac{5}{8}\text{in}$ of room – enough to slide in, not so much that it falls out.

This is a scrap project, and that is the point

Nothing in this pattern is bigger than $3\frac{1}{2}\text{in} \times 4\frac{1}{2}\text{in}$. Those are the pieces left over from a bag, a bow or a bandana – the ones that are too small to be anything and too pretty to throw away. Go to the scrap bin before you go to the shop. **Six little pieces and you have a present.**

What's in this pattern

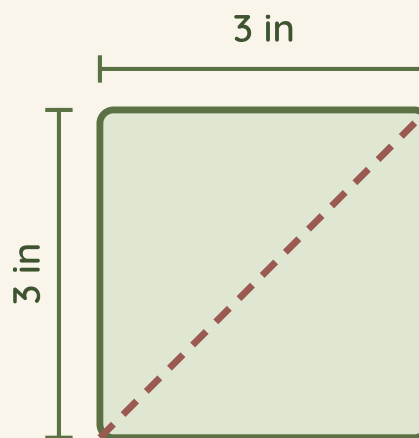
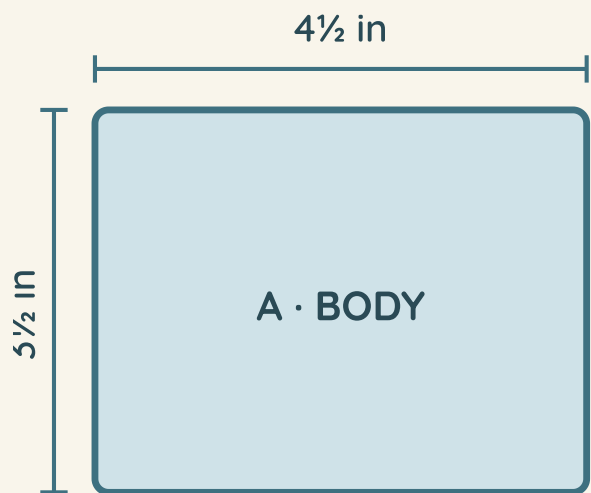
1. This page – materials & sizes
2. The pieces & how they sit
3. Nine steps, start to finish

Four folded corners cross over the front and leave a diamond opening – the card tucks in behind them. No zip, no button, no press stud, and nothing to go wrong.

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The Pieces

Six rectangles, every edge straight. There is nothing to trace and nothing to print at actual size — measure, cut, and you are ready to sew.



fold on the diagonal

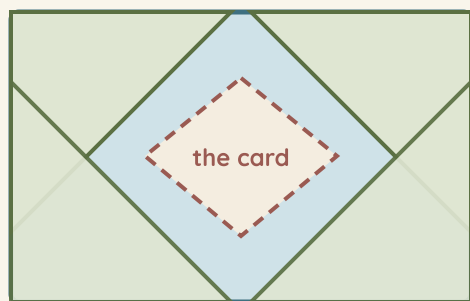
CUT 2
3½in × 4½in

One is the front, one is the lining. **4½in is the width** — it finishes wider than it is tall.

CUT 4
3in × 3in

Each one folds in half corner to corner and becomes a triangle. **Wrong sides together** — the fold is on show.

How they sit



four triangles, folded edges to the middle

Lay the front piece **right side up**. Set a folded triangle into each corner, **raw edges flush with the raw edges of the body** and the folded edges pointing in towards the middle.

They will overlap each other in the centre. **That overlap is the whole design** — the diamond it leaves is where the card goes in.

A 3in square shows almost no pattern, so save a large print for the body and use something small or plain for the corners.

The drawings are not to scale. They are shrunk to fit the page. **Always cut to the written inch measurements**, never by measuring the picture. Every measurement here **includes the ¼in seam allowance**, so cut exactly what it says and add nothing.

Sewing It

Nine steps and about half an hour. **¼in seam allowance throughout.**

1. **Press all six pieces.** They are small, and a crease you sew in stays in.
2. **Fold each 3in square in half on the diagonal**, wrong sides together, and press hard. You now have four triangles with one crisp folded edge each.
3. **Lay one body piece right side up.** This is the front.
4. **Set a triangle into each corner**, raw edges flush with the body's raw edges, folded edges pointing in to the centre. They will overlap in the middle – that overlap is the diamond. Pin or clip.
5. **Baste right round the outside**, just inside the ¼in line, to stop everything shifting. On pieces this small, basting is faster than fighting pins.
6. **Lay the second body piece right side down** on top of the lot, edges matching. Sew **all four sides** at ¼in. There is no gap to leave.
7. **Clip all four corners** on the diagonal, close to the stitching but not through it. Four corners on a piece this small is a great deal of bulk.
8. **Turn it right side out through the diamond.** This is the clever part – the opening you sewed in is also the way out, so there is **no gap to close by hand**. Ease the corners square with a chopstick.
9. **Press it flat**, rolling the seams so neither fabric shows on the other's face. Slide a gift card in to check the fit.

Watch for

- **Press the diagonal folds hard.** A soft fold makes the diamond look accidental instead of designed, and it is the only decoration on the whole piece.
- **Get the four triangles even.** The eye goes straight to the centre.
- **Do not skip the clipping.** Unclipped corners turn out rounded and lumpy.

Make it yours

- **Use two different prints** for the body and the corners – the contrast is what makes it look deliberate.
- **The lining shows at the edges**, so pick something you would happily see.
- Add a length of narrow ribbon in the top seam before step 6 and it hangs on a tree.

If you make one, I would love to see it. Tag [@dragonink_and_thread](#) – and if you would rather have one than make one, they live in the shop.